

RAN GU

Senior Lecturer in Economics, City St George's, University of London
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Employment:

2025-Present	Senior Lecturer, Economics, City St George's, University of London
2018-2025	Lecturer, Economics, University of Essex
2018-Present	Research Associate, Institute for Fiscal Studies
2013-2018	Research Economist and PhD Scholar, Institute for Fiscal Studies

Education:

PhD, Economics, University College London, 2018
Visiting Student, Economics, Yale University, 2016
MRes, Economics, UCL, 2011
MSc, Policy Economics, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, 2010
BA, Economics and Japanese (double degree), Peking University and BFSU, 2009

Research Interests:

Household Finance, Macro Labour, Applied Microeconomics, Wellbeing and Inequality

Publications:

1. "*Durables and Lemons: Private Information and the Market for Cars*" (with Richard Blundell, Soren Leth-Petersen, Hamish Low, and Costas Meghir). **Quantitative Economics**, 2026.
2. "*Does the 'right to request' flexible work policy influence men's and women's uptake of flexible working and well-being — Findings from the UK Household Longitudinal Study*" (with Baowen Xue, Heejung Chung, and Anne McMunn). **Journal of Epidemiology & Community Health**, 2026.
3. "*The Gender Gap in Household Bargaining Power: A Revealed-Preference Approach*" (with Cameron Peng and Weilong Zhang). **Review of Financial Studies**, 2024.
4. "*Effects of Stay-at-home Orders on Skill Requirements in Vacancy Postings*" (with Ling Zhong). **Labour Economics**, Volume 82, 2023.
5. "*Human Capital and the Business Cycle Effects on the Postgraduate Wage Premium.*" **Review of Economic Dynamics**, Volume 48, 2023.

Working Papers:

1. "*Housing Energy Efficiency and the Horizon Effect*" (with Egle Jakucionyte and Swapnil Singh).
2. "*Unemployment Insurance Extensions and the Dynamics of Labour Force Participation*" (with Similan Rujiwattanapong).

Policy Engagement and Knowledge Exchange:

1. "*The lemons penalty: evidence from Denmark's market for second-hand cars.*" Econ Brief, 2026
2. "*Flexible Working Policies Alone Don't Change Workplace Culture, Study Shows.*" Forbes, 2025
3. "*Dads Face Steeper Wage Cuts When Stepping Back From Work in UK.*" Bloomberg, 2025
4. "*Who really holds the purse strings? Why it matters which partner decides where the money goes.*" The Conversation, 2024
5. "*Husbands still dominate investment decisions.*" University of Essex News, 2024
6. "*Can you buy a good second-hand car?.*" The Economist, 2019
7. "*A postgraduate degree protects you against the business cycle.*" LSE Business Review, 2018

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards:

2021	BA/Leverhulme Small Research Grant (9,310 GBP)
2020	Keynes Fund (16,158 GBP)
2013-2015	ESRC PhD Studentship
2011	David Pearce Scholarship, UCL
2010	Excellence for the Future Award, UIUC

Teaching:

2025-Present	Money and Banking (UG) and Macroeconomics (MSc), City St George's
2021-2025	Computational Economics (Machine Learning Focus, MSc Economics with Data Science Core Module), University of Essex
2018-2025	Topics in Macro (Ph.D.-level course), University of Essex
2018-2020	Computational Methods in Agent Based Economics and Policy Simulation, Essex
Pre 2018	Intermediate Macroeconomics, Yale University, TA for Prof. William Nordhaus Intermediate Macroeconomics, Yale University, TA for Prof. Michael Peters Stochastic Frontier and Efficiency Estimation, IFS, TA for Prof William Greene Microsimulation/Microeconometrics, IFS, TA for Prof. Alan Duncan Microeconomics Principle/Intermediate Economics Theory, UIUC

Journal Referee Services:

The Review of Economic Studies (REStud), International Economic Review (IER), Review of Economic Dynamics (RED), Labour Economics, European Economic Review (EER), Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control (JEDC), Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, ILR Review, Oxford Economic Papers, Economic Theory, China Economic Review, Journal of Population Economics, Fiscal Studies, Empirical Economics, Economica, Review of Behavioral Finance, Economics, Routledge.

Programme Committee:

2025-Present	Royal Economic Society Annual Conference
2025-Present	London MEF Meeting
2024	Essex Search and Matching Workshop

Departmental Services:

2024-2025	Co-chair, Athena SWAN Self-Assessment Committee, Essex
2023-2025	Department's Internal Staffing Committee, Essex
2022-2025	Deputy Director for China Recruitment, Essex
2018-2025	Departmental Server Lead, Essex
2018-2021	Seminar Organizer, Essex

PhD Supervision:

Supervisor: Moe Suzuki (current), Guohua He, Deo Sande
Internal Examiner: Pavlos Balamatsias, Kai Zhang, Sofia Bounahai, Junko Iwagami
Chair of Supervisory Board: Taichi Yoshida, Zhixin Feng

Selected Presentations:

2023-2026	UCL, Penn State, Essex, City St George's, Queen Mary, SUFE, SWUFE, RES, AMES
2019-2022	Cambridge, Bristol, SOLE, SED, SEHO, IZA/SOLE Transatlantic Meeting of Labor Economists, RCEA, SWUFE, AASLE, IFS, ES World Congress, Essex SaM Workshop, EEA-ESEM, AMES, CMES, NAMES, ISER, RES
2013-2018	Essex, RES, EIEF, Royal Holloway, IFS, UCL, Yale University, Sciences Po Paris, UCL, Peking University, Xiamen University